BTC 8-Hour Market Report

BTC ~ $81,800

Friday 23 Oct 2026, 15:50 Malaysia time (07:50 UTC)

CoinGecko/CoinGlass ~07:30-07:55 UTC | 24h -0.7% to -1.0% | 7d -0.4%

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral to mildly bearish	**Next 24h:** $80,200 - $83,400 (DVOL ~37, ~1.9% daily move)	**Key floor:** $80,000 (then $79,000 = Oct 30 max pain)	**Big event:** $12B monthly expiry Fri 30 Oct 4pm; FOMC Thu 29 Oct 2am

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

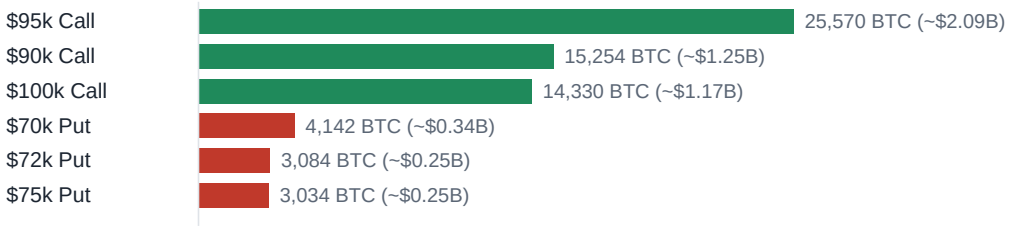
- **Weekly expiry settles today at 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC)**, minutes after this report: ~16,000 BTC (~$1.28B), put/call 1.0, max pain $82,000 (Greeks.live, 22 Oct). After that, only the small Saturday 24 Oct daily expiry (4:00pm MYT) falls inside the next 24 hours.
- Today's expiry is under 4% of total BTC options open interest - big enough to have pinned price near $82k this week, too small to drive the next 24 hours. Once it settles, the pin is released.
- **The expiry that matters is Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm MYT**: ~$12.2B notional (~35% of Deribit BTC OI), put/call 0.52, max pain $79,000 - and it lands one day after the FOMC decision.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
23 Oct (today 4pm)	Balanced book, P/C 1.0	~16,000 BTC total (~$1.28B)	Max pain $82k sat right at spot; settles now, no strike-level breakdown published
24 Oct (Sat 4pm)	Daily - no data seen	Small	Not large enough to move price
30 Oct call	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.09B)	Biggest single strike; far OTM (+16%), decays toward zero unless a big rally
30 Oct put	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)	Tail hedge; puts thin above $75k - downside hedging demand is light

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.28B	1.00	$82,000	No strike breakdown published
Sat 24 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	Small	n/a	n/a	n/a
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B	0.52	$79,000 (Deribit); $81-82k Binance/OKX	Calls $95k 25,570 / $90k 15,254 / $100k 14,330 BTC; Puts $70k 4,142 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,034 BTC
Fri 27 Nov, 4:00pm (monthly)	~26,779 BTC (~$2.2B)	n/a	n/a	Not published
Fri 25 Dec, 4:00pm (quarterly)	Next big date	n/a	~$75,000 (Deribit, 10 Oct)	Not published

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (Deribit, as of 17 Oct)



How options affect the market now

- **Pin released:** today's balanced $1.28B book with max pain at $82k helped keep BTC in a tight $81-83k band. After 4pm MYT that anchor is gone, so a move of 1-2% either way gets easier.
- **Gravity toward $79k into 30 Oct:** Deribit max pain for the $12B monthly is ~$79,000, about 3.5% below spot. Max pain is a weak magnet, but with calls dominating, option sellers profit if BTC drifts lower or stays capped below $84-85k.

- **Call walls far away:** the big $90k / $95k / $100k calls are 10-22% out of the money. They do not cap price now; they only matter (as resistance, then squeeze fuel) if BTC rallies above ~$87k.
- **Light put hedging:** P/C 0.52 and few puts above $75k mean little dealer support from put hedging between $80k and $75k. If $80k breaks, there is no strong options floor until ~$75k.
- **Volatility:** DVOL ~37 is near 5-year lows and implied runs well above realized vol. Low vol + FOMC + a $12B expiry in the same 48 hours raises the chance of a volatility expansion next week rather than in the next 24h.
- **Next 24h verdict:** options are a neutral-to-slightly-bearish factor - no meaningful expiry until 30 Oct, mild pull toward $79-82k max pain zone.

Data note: the Deribit API could not be reached directly this run, so strike sizes come from published analysis (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, Bitcoin.com 10 Oct, Greeks.live 22 Oct) and are the largest positions seen, not a live snapshot. USD sizes = OI x ~$81,800. Positions may have shifted since publication.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC trades ~$81,800 after a 24h range of ~$80,989 - $82,910; it briefly topped $84,800 on Wednesday before reversing with the Nasdaq.
- Thursday's tech sell-off (Nasdaq -2.6%, its biggest drop since June) plus oil spiking on Gulf tensions triggered ~$430-460M of liquidations, about 91% longs.
- Price is sitting right on its 50-day moving average (~$81,300); the 200-day is far below (~$72,400). Trend is flat - up 3% last week, down ~6% over 30 days.
- The range has compressed: Bollinger Band width ~6.5%, among the tightest in 2.5 years - historically a precursor to a larger move.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,800 - $85,000	Wednesday's spike high; rejection point after ETF inflows
Resistance 1	$82,900	Thursday daily high / today's range top
Pivot	$82,000	Today's expiry max pain; mid of the 8h range
Support 1	$80,800 - $81,000	Overnight low, 50-day MA nearby (~$81,300)
Support 2	$80,000	Psychological level cited by options desks as strong support
Deep risk	$79,000 then $76,500	Oct 30 max pain; low end of the options-implied range to 30 Oct; puts only build near $75k

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	~$54.3B (CoinGlass, today)	Still elevated after the flush - leverage only partly cleared
Funding (perps)	+5.4% to +6% annualized (week to 21 Oct)	Mildly positive, not overheated; longs paid but not crowded
Liquidations 24h	~$430-460M, ~91% longs	Long flush done; reduces near-term downside fuel slightly
Spot BTC ETFs	22 Oct: -$635.6M (IBIT -$254M, FBTC -$217M, ARKB -$109M)	Ends a 3-day +$1.07B inflow streak - key reason for the dip
Implied vol (DVOL)	~37 (21 Oct)	Near 5-year lows; ~1.9% implied daily move (~$1,600)
Fear & Greed	47-50 (Neutral)	Down from 68 - sentiment has cooled without panic
Options P/C (total)	~0.66 (10 Oct); 30 Oct 0.52	Call-heavy book; bullish skew longer term

4. News and macro

- **Geopolitics:** Oil at 5-month highs (Brent ~$111.8) after an attack on Saudi energy facilities; Houthis announced a retaliatory campaign and Aramco told HQ staff to evacuate. Reports of US/Israel strike plans on Iran after the US midterms; Trump denies talks.
- **Equities:** Nasdaq -2.6% and S&P 500 -1.2% on 22 Oct as the AI trade wobbled; Nasdaq futures were down another ~1.1% this morning. BTC 30-day correlation with Nasdaq ~0.6.
- **Fed:** Policy rate 3.75-4.00%. FOMC decides Wed 28 Oct (2:00am Thu 29 Oct MYT). September CPI came in hot at 3.7% y/y vs 3.6% expected; jobless claims 194k (strong labour market), which limits room for dovish surprises.
- **Rates:** France 10-year yield (5.08%) rose above the US 10-year for the first time since 2013 - a sign of European bond stress; US yields fell sharply.
- **Regulation / industry:** SEC named firms proposing tokenized-securities platforms under its innovation exemption; Strategy bought 267 BTC on 19 Oct; Drift Protocol exploiter keeps laundering ETH via Tornado Cash.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly BTC options expiry (~$1.28B, max pain $82k)
Sat 24 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily expiry (small)
Tue 27 Oct, 10:00pm	US Conference Board consumer confidence
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am / 2:30am	FOMC rate decision / Powell press conference
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US Q3 GDP (advance) + September PCE inflation
Thu 29 Oct, 9:15pm	ECB rate decision
Fri 30 Oct, ~11:00am	Bank of Japan decision (time approximate)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly BTC options expiry (~$12.2B, max pain $79k)
Tue 3 Nov	US midterm elections
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US October jobs report (expected; US clocks shift 1 Nov)
Fri 27 Nov, 4:00pm	Deribit November monthly expiry

5. Summary and prediction

BTC has pulled back from Wednesday's $84,800 high to ~$81,800 as ETF flows flipped to a $636M outflow, the Nasdaq fell 2.6% and oil spiked on Gulf tensions. The long flush (~$450M) cleared some leverage, funding is only mildly positive and sentiment is neutral, so there is no panic - but there is also no fresh buyer. Today's balanced $1.28B weekly expiry settles at 4pm MYT, releasing the $82k pin; the real catalysts are the FOMC (29 Oct, 2am MYT) and the $12.2B call-heavy monthly expiry the next day, whose $79k max pain sits below spot. With implied vol near 5-year lows, expect range trading for now and a bigger move next week. **24h call: range $80,500-$83,000, slight downside lean; a daily close below $80,000 opens $79k.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range chop	55%	$80,500 - $83,000	Expiry pin released but traders wait for FOMC; ETF flows mixed; weekend liquidity thin
Bearish	25%	$78,800 - $80,500	Loss of $80k on another Nasdaq drop, more ETF outflows or Iran/Saudi escalation lifting oil
Bullish	20%	$83,000 - $85,000	Reclaim of $82,900 with ETF inflows returning and equities stabilising; shorts squeezed toward $84.8k

- **Bullish signal:** hourly close above $82,900 with rising spot volume and positive Coinbase premium; next test $84,800.
- **Bearish signal:** 4h close below $80,000 - little put support until $75k; watch Friday's ETF flow print and Brent above $112.
- Next report: 11:50pm MYT (Fri 23 Oct)

Sources

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